

Sigma Cheat Sheet

Sigma is a generic, YAML-based format for writing detection rules that can be converted into SIEM-specific queries (Splunk SPL, Sentinel KQL, Elastic, and others).

Rule Structure

```
title: Rule Title
id: <unique-uuid>
status: experimental
description: What this rule detects and why
references:
  - https://attack.mitre.org/techniques/T1059/001/
author: Kerry
date: 2026/07/25
logsource:
  category: process_creation
  product: windows
detection:
  selection:
    FileName|modifier: value
  condition: selection
level: high
tags:
  - attack.execution
  - attack.t1059.001
```

Key Fields

Field	Purpose
logsource	Defines what kind of log data the rule applies to (category, product, service)
detection	Contains one or more named selections and the condition combining them
condition	Logic combining selections, e.g. selection1 and not filter
level	Severity: informational, low, medium, high, critical
	Usually MITRE ATT&CK technique

tags	references
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Detection Modifiers

Modifier	What It Does
contains	Field contains the given substring
startswith	Field starts with the given value
endswith	Field ends with the given value
re	Field matches the given regular expression
cidr	Field (an IP) falls within the given CIDR range
all	All listed values must match (default is any/OR)

Combining Logic: AND, OR, NOT

AND — both selections must match

```
detection:
  selection1:
    Image|endswith: '\powershell.exe'
  selection2:
    CommandLine|contains: 'Invoke-WebRequest'
  condition: selection1 and selection2
```

OR — either selection can match

```
detection:
  selection1:
    Image|endswith: '\powershell.exe'
  selection2:
    Image|endswith: '\cmd.exe'
  condition: selection1 or selection2
```

Fields and value lists within one block (implicit AND / OR)

```
detection:
  selection:
    Image|endswith: '\powershell.exe'
    CommandLine|contains:
      - 'Invoke-WebRequest'
```

```
      - 'DownloadFile'
condition: selection
```

NOT — excluding a block from the result

```
detection:
  selection:
    Image|endswith: '\powershell.exe'
  exclude_user:
    User: 'SYSTEM'
condition: selection and not exclude_user
```

Combining AND, OR, and NOT together

```
detection:
  selection:
    Image|endswith: '\powershell.exe'
  keyword1:
    CommandLine|contains: 'Invoke-WebRequest'
  keyword2:
    CommandLine|contains: 'DownloadFile'
  filter:
    CommandLine|contains: 'Get-Help'
condition: selection and (keyword1 or keyword2) and not
filter
```

Detections by Attack Type

Execution — Suspicious PowerShell Download

```
title: Suspicious PowerShell Download
logsource:
  category: process_creation
  product: windows
detection:
  selection:
    Image|endswith: '\powershell.exe'
    CommandLine|contains:
      - 'Invoke-WebRequest'
      - 'DownloadFile'
  condition: selection
level: high
tags:
  - attack.execution
  - attack.t1059.001
```

Persistence — Scheduled Task From a Suspicious Location

```
title: Scheduled Task Created From Temp Directory
logsource:
  category: process_creation
  product: windows
detection:
  selection:
    Image|endswith: '\schtasks.exe'
    CommandLine|contains: '/create'
  filter:
    CommandLine|contains: '\Windows\Temp\'
  condition: selection and filter
level: medium
tags:
  - attack.persistence
  - attack.t1053.005
```

Defense Evasion — Security Tool Disabled via Registry

```
title: Windows Defender Disabled via Registry
logsource:
  category: registry_set
  product: windows
detection:
  selection:
    TargetObject|endswith: '\Windows
Defender\DisableAntiSpyware'
    Details: 'DWORD (0x00000001)'
  condition: selection
level: high
tags:
  - attack.defense_evasion
  - attack.t1562.001
```

Credential Access — LSASS Memory Access

```
title: Suspicious Access to LSASS Process Memory
logsource:
  category: process_access
  product: windows
detection:
  selection:
    TargetImage|endswith: '\lsass.exe'
    GrantedAccess|contains: '0x1010'
  filter:
    SourceImage|endswith:
      - '\taskmgr.exe'
```

```
        - '\procexp64.exe'
    condition: selection and not filter
level: critical
tags:
  - attack.credential_access
  - attack.t1003.001
```

Lateral Movement — PsExec-Style Service Creation

```
title: PsExec Service Creation
logsource:
  category: process_creation
  product: windows
detection:
  selection:
    Image|endswith: '\services.exe'
    CommandLine|contains: 'PSEXESVC'
  condition: selection
level: high
tags:
  - attack.lateral_movement
  - attack.t1021.002
```

Command and Control — DNS Query to a Known Bad Domain

```
title: DNS Query to Known Malicious Domain
logsource:
  category: dns
  product: windows
detection:
  selection:
    QueryName|contains:
      - 'avsvmcloud.com'
      - 'malicious-c2.com'
  condition: selection
level: critical
tags:
  - attack.command_and_control
  - attack.t1071.004
```

Notes

- Sigma rules are platform-agnostic by design — the same rule can be converted to KQL, SPL, or other query languages using tools like `sigma-cli` or `sigmac`.
- A `filter` block paired with `condition: selection and not filter` is the standard way to exclude known-legitimate activity without

writing a separate rule — the exclusion comes from the `not in condition`, not from the block's name.

- Tagging rules with MITRE ATT&CK technique IDs is what makes them easy to map into a broader detection coverage matrix across tactics.